Jaysa (Jay) Rafi

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Current Employment

Williams College

Visiting Assistant Professor of Economics — Jul 2026 – Jun 2028

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — 2021 – 2026

Field Courses: International Macroeconomics, Monetary Economics

MS (Ph.D. Track) in Policy Economics, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — 2019 – 2021

Field Courses: International Macroeconomics, International Trade

MSc in Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science — 2018 – 2019

Field Course: Development and Growth

BSc in Economics, Universitas Indonesia — 2012 – 2016

Research

Working Papers

- "The Effect of U.S. Monetary Policy on Foreign Firms: Does Debt Maturity Matter?" with Sebastiao Oliveira and Pedro Simon. Revise & Resubmit, *Journal of International Economics*.
- "Optimal Sovereign Debt Structure: Evidence and Theory" with Jaewon Choi, Sebastiao Oliveira, and Josef Zechner.
- "Seized Knowledge: Wartime Vesting and the Long-Run Growth of U.S. Innovation" with Lovepreet Singh.
- "Beyond Primary Completion: The Gender Cost of School Access Expansion" with Siho Park.
- "Parental Schooling and Children's Health Behaviors: Evidence from School Expansion in Indonesia" with Siho Park.

Work in Progress

- "Spillover of US Monetary Policy to Asian Economies via Production Networks Channel."

Teaching Experience

Williams College — 2026 – present

- Econ 120: Introductory Macroeconomics, two sections (Spring 2027)
- Econ 232: Financial Markets, Institutions, and Policies (Fall 2026)

- Econ 360: Monetary Economics (Fall 2026)

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2022 – 2026

- Assistant Instructor, MS in Policy Economics Program: Economic Statistics (Fall 2023, 2024, 2025), Econometrics (Spring 2024, 2025, 2026)
- Head Teaching Assistant, iMBA Program, Gies College of Business: Microeconomics for Business, Money and Banking, Leadership and Teams (2022 – 2023)

Work Experience

Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), China Jun – Aug 2023

Economics Department Intern

Economic Research Institute for ASEAN and East Asia (ERIA), Indonesia Jun – Dec 2020

Consultant

Economic Research Institute for ASEAN and East Asia (ERIA), Indonesia Jun 2016 – Jul 2018

Research Associate and Policy Officer

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Robert E. Demarest Memorial Teaching Award, UIUC Department of Economics 2025

UIUC List of Teachers Ranked as Excellent Fall 2023, 2024, 2025; Spring 2024, 2025, 2026

ERIA Microdata Project, with Sebastiao Oliveira and Pedro Simon (US$7,000) 2023 – 2024

Foreign Student Fulbright Scholarship Program (US$70,000) 2019 – 2021

ERIA Employee Scholarship (US$24,000) 2018 – 2019

Invited Seminars and Conference Presentations

ERIA Microdata Project Workshop, 2023, Indonesia; ERIA Microdata Project Workshop, 2024, Japan; Midwest Macro Meeting, 2024, Indiana; Financial Management Association, 2024, Texas; ASSA Poster Presentation, 2025, California; AFA Poster Presentation, 2025, California; Macro Research Group, UIUC; International Economics Seminar, 2025, Universitas Indonesia; Midwest Finance Association, 2026; Williams College, 2026; HKIMR Workshop on Exchange Rates, 2026, Hong Kong*

*Scheduled

Refereeing

Quarterly Review of Economics and Finance (x4), Journal of Corporate Finance

Media Interviews

China Global TV Network, 2018: China – ASEAN Trade Relationship
China Global TV Network, 2018: US – China Trade Tension

Skills

Technical: Stata, R, Matlab, LaTeX, MS Office
Languages: English (fluent), Indonesian (native)
Databases: Bloomberg, CEIC, Refinitiv, Compustat, Bankfocus, Orbis

References

Dr. Greg Howard (Associate Professor of Economics, UIUC – Primary Advisor) | glhoward@illinois.edu
Dr. Dan Bernhardt (Professor of Economics, UIUC) | danber@illinois.edu
Dr. Shihan Xie (Assistant Professor of Economics, UIUC) | shihanx@illinois.edu